

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Power, Authority, Legitimacy and Influence

CENTRAL FOCUS

Power, Authority, Legitimacy and Influence

[1] Power secures effects; authority is power accepted as rightful.

|
v

[2] Legitimacy explains willing compliance while influence works without direct force.

|
v

[3] Gauba's formula authority equals power plus legitimacy anchors the topic.

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v

[4] Consent must still be tested for manipulation, exclusion and unequal resources.

|
v

VERDICT -> Authority adds accepted rightfulness to the capacity called power.

ANSWER USE -> Define all four adjacent concepts before comparing them.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Power Forms, Core Distinctions and Chapter Spine

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Power Forms, Core Distinctions and Chapter Spine

[1] Political, economic and ideological power operate through different resources.

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v

[2] Coercion threatens sanctions; hegemony organises consent in civil society.

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v

[3] Power over identifies domination; power to identifies capacity and resistance.

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v

[4] A complete answer asks who rules, by what means and with what acceptance.

|

v

VERDICT -> Power travels through resources, coercion, belief and capacity.

ANSWER USE -> State the mechanism and location rather than only naming a thinker.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Weber, Marx, Gramsci and Classical Elite Theory

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Weber, Marx, Gramsci and Classical Elite Theory

[1] Weber classifies traditional, charismatic and legal-rational authority.

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v

[2] Marx and Engels locate political power in class ownership and production.

|
v

[3] Gramsci adds hegemony, civil society and relative autonomy.

|
v

[4] Pareto, Mosca, Michels and Mills analyse different forms of minority rule.

|
v

VERDICT -> Authority, class, hegemony and elite organisation locate power differently.

ANSWER USE -> Attach every thinker to one mechanism and one limitation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Pluralism, Deep Power, Feminism and Constructive Power

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Pluralism, Deep Power, Feminism and Constructive Power

[1] Pareto and Mosca explain circulation among ruling minorities.

|
v

[2] Michels explains the organisational tendency toward oligarchic leadership.

|
v

[3] Elite turnover can coexist with oligarchy; the claims are not strict opposites.

|
v

[4] Pluralism, Lukes, feminism, Arendt and Macpherson widen the power map.

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v

VERDICT -> Elite circulation and organisational oligarchy can coexist.

ANSWER USE -> Compare personnel turnover with control of organisational machinery.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Comparisons, Traps, Boundaries and Source Discipline

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Comparisons, Traps, Boundaries and Source Discipline

[1] Visible decisions form the first dimension of power.

|
v

[2] Agenda exclusion forms the second; preference shaping forms the third.

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v

[3] The third dimension is a contested hypothesis, not a proven finding.

|
v

[4] Arendt and Macpherson restore collective and developmental power to the analysis.

|
v

VERDICT -> Each dimension deepens power analysis but raises a harder evidence burden.

ANSWER USE -> Treat preference shaping as a contestable hypothesis, not a finding.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Theses, Directives and Perspective Selection

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Theses, Directives and Perspective Selection

[1] A thesis must distinguish capacity, rightfulness and willing compliance.

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v

[2] Directive control decides whether one perspective or several must be compared.

|
v

[3] Elite answers separate circulation of personnel from organisation-level oligarchy.

|
v

[4] Digital answers distinguish public, private and hybrid power.

|
v

VERDICT -> Directive control prevents power theories from becoming an unranked list.

ANSWER USE -> Select dimensions and perspectives that answer the exact demand.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Elite-Theory Debate, Evidence and Mark Scaling

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Elite-Theory Debate, Evidence and Mark Scaling

[1] Authority is more stable than force because legitimacy lowers coercive costs.

|
v

[2] Lukes replies that apparent consent may itself be shaped by deeper power.

|
v

[3] The objection is difficult to verify without observable mechanisms.

|
v

[4] Use defaults, exclusions and barriers to contestation before claiming false interests.

|
v

VERDICT -> Consent may legitimate authority or reveal hegemony and hidden domination.

ANSWER USE -> Test acceptance through contestability, resources and alternatives.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Digital Power: Panopticism, Data and the Three Dimensions

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Digital Power: Panopticism, Data and the Three Dimensions

[1] Panopticism explains self-policing under uncertain observation.

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v

[2] Data power adds asymmetric knowledge, ranking, prediction and automated discretion.

|
v

[3] Foucault, Zuboff and Pariser are extensions beyond Gauba and remain paraphrased.

|
v

[4] The M.A.N.A.V. vision supplies a current ethical-governance anchor.

|
v

VERDICT -> Digital power extends classical mechanisms without erasing provenance limits.

ANSWER USE -> Mark Foucault, Zuboff and Pariser as later conceptual extensions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Surveillance Asymmetry, Consent and the Public-Private Boundary

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Surveillance Asymmetry, Consent and the Public-Private Boundary

[1] Surveillance can chill association, hide criteria and aggregate minor observations.

|
v

[2] Formal consent may be thin when terms are unread and participation is necessary.

|
v

[3] Platform power strains public accountability and ordinary market exit.

|
v

[4] Legitimate power requires explanation, review and meaningful answerability.

|
v

VERDICT -> Private and hybrid power expose an accountability gap beyond state coercion.

ANSWER USE -> Ask who decides, who can challenge and whether exit is meaningful.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Objections, Puttaswamy Boundary and Digital Answer Architecture

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Objections, Puttaswamy Boundary and Digital Answer Architecture

[1] Puttaswamy is used only as a structured-justification conceptual anchor.

|
v

[2] No statutory, programme or current regulatory detail is authored here.

|
v

[3] Three objections test voluntariness, unfalsifiability and state-centrism.

|
v

[4] A graded verdict separates technological capacity from rightful authority.

|
v

VERDICT -> Structured justification, not technological novelty, is the legitimacy test.

ANSWER USE -> Conclude with legality, proportionality, explanation and review.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

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MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

[1] Close options test power versus authority and coercion versus hegemony.

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v

[2] They separate Weber's types, elite mechanisms and the three power dimensions.

|
v

[3] Michels does not prove permanent, unchanging oligarchy in every organisation.

|
v

[4] Third-dimensional preference shaping must not be asserted as an established fact.

|
v

VERDICT -> Close options turn on mechanism, depth, location and source boundary.

ANSWER USE -> Reject overclaims about permanent oligarchy or manufactured preferences.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

CENTRAL FOCUS

PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

[1] No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this topic.

|
v

[2] Six original questions test concepts, elite theory, pluralism and digital power.

|
v

[3] A strong answer adds Arendt or Macpherson as a constructive counterpoint.

|
v

[4] Final recall: capacity becomes authority only through legitimate answerability.

|
v

VERDICT -> Original practice integrates classical power with its digital extension.

ANSWER USE -> End by separating bare capacity from legitimate and answerable authority.